IPAM Lisboa

Continuous Evaluation – Group project

Title:

Enhancing the Employer Branding for PwC Portugal in the Digital/IT Landscape

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Submitted on: 12.12.2023, Lisbon

Executive Summary

In response to the evolving professional services landscape, PwC Portugal is addressing the need to improve its employer branding strategy, with a focus on recruiting and retaining digital/IT talent. The initial problem is the growing global demand for IT specialists, which has only been increased by the special challenges of the COVID-19 pandemic. The rise in remote work has showcased the need for skilled IT staff and further intensified the competition for top talent. PwC Portugal aims to address this challenge by defining an innovative and targeted employer branding strategy that not only attracts qualified IT professionals but also promotes a workforce that is aligned with the company's values and vision.

Several diverse solutions will be developed for the mentioned problem that is identified throughout the report. The solutions aim not only to ease the shortage of IT specialists but also to establish PwC Portugal as an employer of choice in the highly competitive industry. The developed strategies include collaborative initiatives called “Power IT up” with colleges and universities, offering internships and scholarships, as well as adopting an omnichannel approach to engage potential talent. In addition, website improvements, investments in alternative recruitment channels, and the organization of hackathons are suggested to create a dynamic and attractive employer branding. These solutions are tailored to the specific challenges faced by PwC Portugal.

In conclusion, the comprehensive report provides a strategic roadmap to address the challenges and opportunities in attracting and retaining world-class IT talent. The proposed strategies are guided by industry trends, academic findings, and the specific organizational context of PwC Portugal, positioning the company as an employer of choice in the competitive IT landscape.

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Introduction

In the dynamic professional services landscape, PwC has emerged as a prominent player, securing its position as the world's second-largest professional services network within the prestigious Big Four. With a changing global workforce and ever-increasing demand for top talent, PwC Portugal is challenged to optimize its employer branding strategy, particularly targeting individuals with digital/IT expertise in a B2B context.

This report focuses on the critical task of formulating the most effective employer branding strategy for PwC Portugal to attract and retain Digital/IT talent. As the business world experiences the increasing importance of endomarketing and internal communications, our report examines how PwC Portugal can use these principles to not only attract qualified IT professionals but also to cultivate a workforce that is seamlessly aligned with the company's values and also matches the company's vision.

Our research question revolves around identifying the strategies that PwC Portugal can use to successfully enhance its employer branding, specifically focusing on the recruitment and attraction of the best IT talents. In a time characterized by a shortage of skilled workers and intense competition for talent in various industries, building and maintaining a strong employer brand is essential. This strategic approach aims to position PwC Portugal as an attractive employer that makes a significant contribution to attracting and retaining employees.

The term "employer branding" refers to the development and maintenance of a company's employer brand. This includes the strategic positioning to address the increasing shortage of skilled workers and the intense competition for talent. A strong employer brand should connect the company's values, human resources strategy, and policies while remaining closely linked to the overarching corporate brand. Embedded in this construct are the ethical standards that the organization adheres to through the practices of its employees.

In the course of this report, we will first describe the organizational context in more detail and define our research question. This includes an analysis of PwC Portugal's field of activity as well as other relevant information about the company. The following chapter deals with the theoretical analysis. In the course of this the relevant theoretical topics and models are identified which will provide the foundation for the further report. We then look at the method and the results. The existing problem will be analyzed based on the research question,

the theoretical context, as well as the results, and several possible solutions will be presented. Finally, the conclusions are drawn, and the main aspects of the report are summarized. With this journey, we aim to provide PwC Portugal with a strategic roadmap to address the challenges and opportunities in attracting and retaining world-class IT talent.

Organizational context and Research question

PwC is the world's second-largest professional services network, and it is one of the Big Four (the four largest professional services network in the world) along with Deloitte, EY, and KPMG.

To be clear in this business none of these firms are actually just a single firm, since they are global networks capable to provide a wide scope of professional services to their clients: assurance services, management consulting, valuations, market researches, actuarial science, corporate finance, legal services, and audit (most of the audits of public and private companies are always conducted by PwC or one of these four networks).
It was estimated that in 2012 - according to the Financial Times - the Big Four had about 67% share of this global market, while mid-tier players like BDO, Crowe Global and Grant Thornton shared the majority of the remaining funds.

PwC has four global lines of service: Assurance, Advisory, Internal firm services; Tax and Legal service. Its network is active in 688 different cities across 152 countries and relies on 328,000 people worldwide that collectively have more than 191,000 clients.
PwC firms provide its services to 84% of the companies on the list *Fortune Global 500* (an annual ranking of the top 500 corporations worldwide as measured by revenue, compiled and published by *Fortune* magazine).
They are also one of the most profitable companies in the world, having 50,3 billion revenues in 2022 and a rise to reach the record of US$53.1 billion in 2023 (fiscal year).
“The New Equation” is the name of the global strategy of PwC, that aims to fulfill its purpose to build trust in society and solve important challenges in today’s and tomorrow’s world.

PwC has 4 locations in Portugal, spread across the offices in Lisbon, Oporto, Coimbra and Funchal. Across the country PwC has 61 partners and more than 2,100 permanent employees.

A significant part of them are in the Assurance team - which counts 974 people -, while the rest of the staff numbers is splitted into the Tax and Legal team (601 workers), the Advisory (601), and “just” 243 people in the Internal firm services team.

Regarding the IT sector, this is one of the fastest-growing industries and as a consequence needs a growing number of qualified professionals; indeed, by 2030 it is estimated that there will be a shortage of over 85 million tech workers.

By applying this topic to the Portuguese market we have to consider how Portugal has seen dramatic changes in this market in recent years.
Geographic and cultural barriers have been removed as a consequence of the widespread adoption of remote work, allowing tech talent to work remotely not only for Portuguese companies but also for companies across borders.
Foreign firms saw this as an opportunity and moved quickly to hire Portuguese tech talent to work remotely from Portugal. If last year's figure of 18.6% of Portuguese professionals working remotely across borders was impressive, this year's figure is even higher (22.6%).
This phenomenon has had a significant impact on both the availability of local talent and salaries, which local businesses are beginning to recognize.

However, Portuguese firms have yet to accept the globalization of technology work. Only 10.6% of the Portuguese labor force is foreign-born. Unless companies start hiring and relocating tech professionals from other countries, the local talent shortage will get even worse. Competition for talent is fierce, and recruitment strategies must be scrutinized — for some businesses, it may be a matter of life and death.

Thus, after these considerations, and according to the Global Tech Talent Report 2023, it is objective to state the problem of portuguese employers to find the right IT talents (67% of the companies struggle to find the right candidates and according to the 73% of recruiters IT profiles are the most difficult to hire).

Research question

Which strategies could PwC use to successfully enhance its Employer Branding in order to attract and recruit the best IT talents?

Theoretical Analysis

In order to attract and retain the best IT talent in the current competitive landscape, it is mandatory to have a strong employer branding strategy that differentiates the organization from its competitors and enhances its attractiveness to potential employees. It encompasses the overall image and reputation of an organization as an employer, shaping how potential candidates perceive its work environment, culture, and values. (Pais, 2020)

The foundation of effective employer branding lies in the definition and articulation of a strong and clear Employer Value Proposition (EVP). An EVP is a concise statement that outlines the unique benefits and experiences that an organization offers to its employees. It articulates what makes working for a particular company different from other options, emphasizing the specific factors that attract and retain high-performing talent.

After the EVP is established, it's necessary to correctly determine the channels that will be used to get in touch with the most adequate candidates, not only for the job position, but also to integrate the team.

Afterwards, comes the selection phase, which should be organized in a way that makes it agile. Many candidates complain about how time-consuming and complex this process can be, and, to keep them motivated and in a position that is favorable for the company, it should try to keep it simple and fast, while always providing clear feedback, even to candidates who were rejected. This is why the Human Resources department should be in cohesion with the rest of the sectors in the company.

After the Selection phase, companies enter the Retainment phase, which means keeping the hired employees in the firm, especially focusing on diminishing turnovers. To do this, they should listen to professionals as that is essential to understand their demands and what can be done to make the environment even more attractive.

Posteriorly, the cycle comes to the Attrition phase, where staff that don't fit into the organization's culture, or its people, tend to leave the company. This has a positive impact on the company, if foreseen, since the collaborators will create a more homogeneous group, compared to the one initially attracted. and create a stronger team culture that will lead to better results.

All these sections of the cycle come full circle by always being interconnected with the organizational goals. Companies always have to have in mind the objectives of the Recruitment Team and Talent Management Team. The conciliation of these initiatives will hopefully lead to a better recruitment system and results. (Schneider, 2022)

To reach these conclusions, we based our work on previous academic studies, such as *The ASA framework: An update*, by Benjamin Schneider, Harold W. Goldstein et Brent Smith; *The People Make the Place*, by Benjamin Schneider; and *Employer Value Proposition: Atração de jovens na área das Tecnologias de Informação*, by Ana Lúcia de Jesus Andrade Pais. These academic works are mentioned in the References section, at the bottom of the report, due to their influence on the whole project.

The demand for IT professionals has been consistently rising, with a particular shortage in core roles such as data analysts, software developers, systems administrators, mobile developers, cybersecurity experts, and helpdesk technicians.

Prior to the pandemic, projections indicated that there would be a shortage of 800,000–1 million IT workers by 2020. The situation was further exacerbated by the COVID-19 pandemic, as the need for IT expertise and digital infrastructure increased due to the quick transition to remote work. These factors caused a rapid rise in the need for specialized professionals in order to facilitate a smooth transition and sustain productivity. Bearing all of this in mind, the technology sector (both IT and ICT) is one of the fastest-growing industries, and as a result, the need for qualified professionals grows constantly. Other factors that contribute to this growth include the growing necessity of having a (reasonable) internet connection at all times and the ever-growing complexity of technologies for different work environments that need to be developed and maintained. LinkedIn's chief economist, Karin Kimbrough, states that the company anticipates creating nearly 150 million new tech jobs over the next five years. Furthermore, by 2030, there will be a global shortage of over 85 million tech workers, roughly equivalent to Germany's population, predicts management consulting firm Korn Ferry. If left unchecked, this could result in an annual loss of revenue of $8.5 trillion (€8 trillion).

In an effort to learn more about Portugal's talent shortages, Michael Page presented research on the lack of talent in Portugal based on a sample of 150 recruiters from businesses of all sizes in the nation. In the results report, when asked if the IT sector had become less appealing over the past two years, 36% responded that it had become even more so; 32% said

that while it was still attractive, it had lost some of its appeal; and 22.67% said that nothing had changed. Merely 9.33% believe that the industry is currently less in demand. However, the increased need for tech talent is a global issue, not just one that affects Europe.

As for the profiles that are more difficult to hire now than 24 months ago, the IT/Technology areas come first with 72.97% of responses, followed by Managers with 49.32% and recent graduates with 43.24%.

In spite of this, a survey conducted by the Talent Portugal platform shows that thirteen international service centers with operations in Portugal anticipate hiring 3,700 new employees over the next two years. To that end, they are already taking steps to "capture more and better candidates," increasing the investment in their employer branding strategy (a tactic to enhance the company's perception among candidates and employees). They also are focusing on trying to "recycle" profiles, concentrating on drawing in foreign talent, assisting public entities in promoting this industry, and fortifying their ties to Portuguese universities.

Due to the drastic increase in demand for specialists in this field, and the lack of qualified professionals, the salaries for this field have consequently increased. The mismatch between demand and supply was so significant that, in 2020, there was a 30% increase in the remuneration of IT professionals, according to Revelo, a job vacancy platform. Therefore, paying well is a differentiator, but it is also the market’s default value proposition, for that reason, it will not guarantee the maintenance of these employees, not translating into a sustainable EVP. Despite this, with teleworking facilitating the global economy, multinationals are increasingly recruiting IT professionals from Portugal, being able to provide higher salaries, which creates a problem for national technology companies that are at risk of losing the best talent.

In an interview with Diário de Notícias, Victor Batista, CEO and co-founder of Present Technologies (a software development company), stated that the physical barriers created by the COVID-19 pandemic affected the IT field in the opposite direction. The inevitability of digitalization and globalization led to a swift rise in salaries. For companies that work mainly for the domestic market, this issue is even more sensitive, as they sell their products at "national" prices, but pay their human resources at international prices. These businesses will experience difficulties post-covid, and there will have to be an important adjustment phase. But, on the other hand, this also represents opportunities for some national companies to recruit outside the country, for example, in Brazil.

When questioned about Portugal's greatest advantage when it comes to human capital, the managers cited "the qualification of the resources" as their top choice, citing things like technical skill levels and "excellent quality/price ratio" as well as other valued considerations. Finally, the primary benefits and factors that supported the nation's decision to establish its service centers—which from Portugal cater to several other nations—are the accomplishments of previously established operations, geopolitical stability, integration in Europe, and geographic location.

As a consequence, the increased desirability of Portuguese employees by foreign companies amplifies the efforts national companies must exert to retain their human capital. This entails investing in training, skill development, and addressing their employees' needs and desires. Consequently, the organizational culture of companies becomes pivotal. These sought-after profiles are typically youthful, dynamic, and innovative, valuing the autonomy to make decisions and experiment. In addition to prioritizing work-life balance and mental health, 45% of women and 40% of men consider overcoming challenges and skill development as the most relevant aspects of their careers. This directly ties to the second most valued skill – working towards a greater purpose. Furthermore, they are conventionally pragmatic and stay in organizations for short periods of time, due to being open to new offers (even though they don’t usually seek positions), new challenges, and/or better pay grades.

Recruiting IT technicians presents numerous challenges, including the notable shortage of female professionals available for these roles. Many companies uphold policies promoting workplace equality and diversity, requiring the representation of women and other minorities in their workforce. However, the limited presence of women in the IT field poses a significant hurdle. Female professionals in this domain often report experiencing prejudice or feeling compelled to prove their technical competence, presenting a notable obstacle to achieving greater diversity in the industry.

Based on this data, it becomes evident that not only is the recruitment of women crucial in the technology sector, but it is equally essential to ensure they are embraced and work in a supportive environment. Furthermore, McKinsey's research indicates that companies with gender diversity in executive roles have a 21% higher likelihood of achieving above-average profits compared to those lacking such diversity. This figure rises to 33% when considering ethnic diversity. Consequently, when hiring technology professionals, due consideration must be given to the inclusion of women in the workforce.

A common challenge in hiring IT personnel is the mismatch between the required soft skills and those possessed by the candidates. In a recent survey, 48.67% of respondents

acknowledged this discrepancy, while 28% cited a skills gap, 16.67% indicated a lack of relevant skills, and 6.67% pointed to insufficient academic qualifications.

Another significant issue hindering the hiring process is the inadequacy of candidates' resumes or their incompatibility with the company's culture. Nearly half of the surveyed individuals admitted these concerns.

These findings highlight the importance of evaluating candidates holistically, considering not only their technical expertise but also their soft skills and cultural fit. By addressing these critical aspects, organizations can make more informed hiring decisions and attract top IT talent.

As the demand for personnel grows, securing IT professionals remains a significant challenge for many companies, and this is likely to persist in the foreseeable future. Outsourcing IT services can, therefore, serve as a solution, whether temporary or not, to address the shortage of these professionals. Opting for outsourcing can yield advantages that might not be achievable otherwise. Engaging with an experienced IT partner can bring substantial time savings, providing access to a diverse range of resources, possibilities, and expertise, all in one package — a significant advantage.

Numerous companies lack the resources to directly update their IT infrastructure and software to align with their organizational needs. This implies that, especially for SMEs, they can greatly benefit in terms of cost by outsourcing these services, gaining access to IT resources and solutions that would be considerably challenging to acquire independently.

Investing in cutting-edge IT technologies to enhance a company's management and operations is costly and, In most cases, IT outsourcing involves a fixed monthly fee, facilitating cost control and robust financial planning. SMEs, when outsourcing their IT functions to a professional company, can also leverage scalable IT technologies.

Method and results

The objective of our research is to find ways to succeed in attracting talent in the IT field (as already made explicit in previous chapters). To achieve this, several factors must be taken into account: we have considered where the resources we need may be located (i.e. what channels they prefer, which is why we have expanded the contact channels to include Facebook groups and Telegram), the creation of "hackathon" events (events that attract this type of profile, the nature of which will be explored in more detail further on) and creating an

offer that is attractive in itself. Another approach we want to take concerns young talents: investing in their instruction could be a way to attract talents as soon as they get out of high school, and by this, have the possibility to develop their potential internally from the beginning. Therefore, the strategy we seek is based on an **omnichannel vision that allows us to reach IT profiles while minimizing the resources and time needed for recruitment**, with a specific focus on creating a compelling profile for PWC Portugal itself as a company that can welcome and help in the development of these professionals (an all-inclusive employer branding). In the next paragraphs, we will go more into detail about what we have already exposed in this introduction.

Program from the internships: "Power IT up!"

"In today's competitive landscape, we strategically invest in campus recruitment efforts. Through this initiative, we reach the best candidates where they are and when they are most open to new opportunities. Our goal is to educate, attract and sign on industry newcomers at the exact time that they are looking to enter the workforce."

- Darren Person, NPD Group

of Darren Person (writer for Forbes) that we read on forbes concerning the topic

This quote inspired us to think about a program that would also suit PWC Portugal itself. The program involves collaboration with several professional high schools with an IT focus on PWC's main offices in Portugal: Coimbra, Funchal, Lisbon, and Porto. At the same time, we are also starting a collaboration with several universities that offer IT courses in Portugal. When examining how the programs work at these schools, we recognized great potential: at the end of the five years, students must earn credits from professionalization internships. PWC could insert itself into this by offering interested young people the chance to do a short internship in the company, which can be followed by another opportunity for the talents who stand out: **the idea is to create a scholarship offered by PwC Portugal for a bachelor's degree in IT-related subjects.**

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Winners will have the opportunity to work part-time at PwC and get paid, while having their tuition fees fully covered as long as they remain in the company. The name chosen for the project is "**Power IT up!**", a line that is aligned with PwC's values in terms of "reimagine the possible", to give the possibility for talented minds to develop their future and grow in a company that can cultivate their potential.

Tennagers > guys and girls that are truly passionate about IT market

In 2020 it was McDonald's itself that implemented this type of strategy in Portugal: the program is called 'Up- Programa Nacional de Bolsas de Estudo' and is still going strong, gaining a lot of consensus and adhesions. The concept is simple: with an investment of EUR 200.000 per year, McDonald's offers EUR 1.000 scholarships to students working in the company, so that they can contribute to their education while working for the company.

Another well-known company that offers such scholarships is Santander: the bank offers a real 'Academy' section in which the company offers different scholarships depending on the different areas in which they want to study.

The motivations behind the proposal to offer a scholarship are various: it benefits the **reputation** of the brand (whose image will be more associated with the IT world) , it increases **awareness** (thanks to the series of collaborations and connections that could be created by implementing this strategy) but above all the **retention** of the workers themselves who, thanks to programs such as these, acquire new skills that also lead to greater efficiency in the management of tasks in the company .

Finally, it also offers great benefits on the **SEO** side, an aspect that we will elaborate on in the next section.

WebsITe improvements

Trying to attract talent in IT also means looking for people who are in demand in many other companies, which is why it is important to offer a job application platform that is intuitive, fast and gives the right image of the company. That is the reason why it is important for PwC Portugal to increase the ease of the interface on their website. One thing we noticed as soon as we entered the site is that the 'careers' section cannot be displayed in English. If the intention is to attract talent and increase the target pool, one of the first things to do is to make this section available entirely in English. Another suggestion would be to create a separate section within the site with specific access for those working in IT. A real landing page with a simple and intuitive interface entirely focused on recruiting these people, who would not waste time searching through the various careers available, but would immediately see not only the open positions but also the various benefits reserved for them by PwC Portugal. Things that could certainly be included are the possibility of helping non-Europeans

to obtain a VISA, the possibility of 100% smart working, and growth opportunities, which, according to various research, seem to be most attractive to IT talent.

Investing in new channels

According to an article published by Forbes using social media and alternative contact channels could be a great way to attract people from the IT field. These types of platforms can create an advantage against the competition because they allow talent to be attracted even when they are not actively looking for a job. So even when faced with 'passive' professionals, through the use of social media we would be able to reach them. This can be achieved by first thinking about starting a collaboration with some influencers in the tech field who are very popular within our target audience. During our search, we found a profile that could fit our needs very well: it is **Nuno Agonia**, an influencer with more than 450.000 followers on Instagram. His videos contain reviews of technical products, but it could also be possible to arrange a collaboration with the influencer, for example, to promote the Power It Up initiative that was previously explained, or even the technical courses that are available within the PWC Portugal premises.

Investing in specific job platforms such as **Blind, Built In** or **Wellfounds**, could be an additional investment: these platforms are specific job portals for people working in the IT sector that are highly frequented by professionals from all over the world and are cheaper than Linkedin in terms of listings.

But our question went even further: we asked ourselves which channels are most frequented by people working in IT, and after an in-depth search we discovered a huge selection of websites used by them for networking. Besides the 'standard' platforms such as Instagram or Linkedin, the other platforms identified are:

- **100 AM**- an event networking platform, made for the exchanges of business cards. This platform could be used for more direct recruiting of IT profiles with very specific requirements.
- **Elpha**- which offers advice, job information, and support for women working in technology. This community supports women working or studying in STEM and is a great way to search for talented women with IT experience.

- **Facebook groups** - while it may seem outdated, Facebook groups are an option that many people working in tech still consider. A simple advertisement on a Facebook group without any costs would lead to a very high profile reach.

The great thing about these platforms is that they are frequented almost entirely by the target audience we are trying to reach, so they could represent a net saving in recruiting costs but also lead to a high turnout of CVs.

These platforms, in addition to their attractiveness purpose, could also be used to promote the courses that PWC is already implementing and the tech events that will be discussed in the next section.

Events that challenge: the "hackathons"

Figuring out how to attract people who work in IT has also allowed us to discover many things we didn't know about before: this also applies to so-called **hackathons**, popular events for web development enthusiasts, where a "marathon" of developing a website or application from scratch takes place in one day. Hackathons not only provide a platform for applicants to demonstrate their skills and expertise but also offer businesses insights into their customers and clients. They are also becoming increasingly popular for attracting talent. A case in point is Google's annual Android Developer Challenge, where developers have the opportunity to craft mobile apps for the company's ecosystem. Such events enable individuals lacking experience to showcase their abilities. By emphasizing qualities like creativity, communication skills, leadership, and problem-solving abilities, **these events effectively mitigate biases often associated with traditional hiring methods**.

Offline Hackathons typically span 1–2 days, challenging participants to tackle a given problem within a constrained time frame. These events force individuals to step out of their comfort zones and subject them to tight time pressures. **This environment encourages individuals to take risks and explore new ideas**, a scenario not commonly encountered in a standard 9-5 workday.
Those motivated to stretch their creative capabilities in this unique setting experience a fluid exchange of original ideas, not only among teammates but also within themselves.

Consequently, hackathons yield innovative solutions for the problems they are designed to address.

This could give PwC a head start on prototypes with market potential and in return offer a place in the company or other prizes. This recognition could encourage freelancers and professionals to join, helping the firm to identify and integrate top talent. **With just one event you could not only find what you are searching for, but also create an entire database of talented people that you could use for hiring in the future.**

They present a marketing opportunity for host corporations, particularly crucial for those aiming to recruit top talent. Established companies are attractive to job seekers due to their reputation and pose a challenge for startups to attract committed employees. Generating significant buzz about the host firm, **they position it as a dynamic market player, especially if industry experts and technical consultants assess the event**. The increasing popularity of hackathons makes it easier to secure sponsors for financial support, enhancing branding efforts.

The type of hackathon that PwC could use is the so-called "industry hackathon" like the one already organized by Red Bull "Hack the Hits" - this type of event creates a connection between talent seekers and possible candidates. It comes with several benefits:

- **Cost reduction**: Hackathons significantly cut recruitment costs compared to traditional methods, with the potential to hire multiple candidates at a much lower average cost per hire of $4.425 (EUR 4.110). Many companies are increasingly favoring hackathons due to their cost-effectiveness, especially when conducted online.
- **Time efficiency:** Utilizing these events in recruitment shortens the length of the hiring process by 80%, allowing recruits to quickly assimilate into the company culture and receive essential training. This reduces training time from 3-6 months to less than 6 weeks.

reduce le lenght of the process

- **Efficient screening:** Hackathons offer a more effective screening alternative compared to traditional processes. Traditional hiring processes often result in only 50% of hires meeting expectations, taking almost three months to determine if the right hire has been made. In contrast, hackathons simplify screening by allowing a

better efficient screening

quick assessment of a candidate's teamwork, technical skills, cognitive abilities, and behavioral competencies.

- **Enhanced diversity:** Online hackathons enable recruiters to attract a diverse pool of high-quality talent, reaching candidates from non-traditional recruiting fields. This diversity broadens access to potentially more talented individuals, enriching the organization beyond traditional recruitment sources.

different field, different educational backgrounds

PwC is not new to these types of events: in other countries like China, several hackathons were organized. One of them was "Hack a Day: securing AI", which was a huge success: if you click here you will see the highlights of the event.

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So the event, which can be called "PwC Hackathon: Innovating Recruitment" can be structured as a hackathon and be used by PwC to recruit IT talents. The main topic could be the development of the platform we already talked about, the landing page for searching IT careers at PwC, but also the call for an innovative project that can serve as a networking space for employees and the prize could be a spot in a PwC Portugal team. This initiative could give great resonance to the brand itself, while increasing the credibility of the brand as a talent hub for IT professionals.

Conclusions

We started the work by analyzing PwC's scope of activity to understand the market in which the company operates and who its main competitors are, and then focused exclusively on the company itself.
After studying and understanding who PwC is, the values, the structure of the company and the services it offers, we started researching their presence on Portuguese territory.
Finally, once we have gathered all of the necessary information, we have outlined our research question and it was then determined which possible solutions could be implemented in this specific situation.

Therefore we got to the heart of the problem and we listed - first briefly and then carefully and more detailed all the ideas that are part of our strategy.
To try to attract more IT talent, we have considered a variety of initiatives, ranging from the most simple and achievable (e.g the website improvements and the different job platforms) to

the most demanding (e.g the scholarships), up to the most creative and utopian (e.g, the Hackathons).

Throughout the course of this project, we learned many things, not only about the topics covered in our Talent and Change Management course, but also about information, curiosities and details about the job market through a global company like PwC.
In order to find answers for our research question, once we defined the picture of the situation, we outlined together what possible strategies for our goal could look like and once we clarified the situation we threw ourselves into a brainstorming process to come up with more creative alternative solutions.
After we gathered enough ideas, we decided together which ones should be discarded and which ones could be implemented in our work.
Thus, once we agreed on the most important common guidelines for the project, we split the work up to allow each member of the group to work to the best of his abilities.

We believe that we approached the project with the appropriate seriousness and commitment, but surely, in retrospect, some of the choices we made could be looked at differently.
The decision to do a brainstorming process together was definitely correct, but perhaps we needed to do it more frequently and several times during the project. Some of the ideas and decisions we made together could have had a more mature perspective when analyzing and designing the project if we had chosen a different process. Dividing the work once we had all agreed on what to do certainly benefited the speed and execution of the project, but in turn reduced the key component that remains in a collective project, namely the strength of the group itself.
This is definitely something that needs to be improved and therefore we aim in the future to have more group discussions among us, with the ultimate aim of doing a great work that can be of an even higher quality.

To conclude, we would like to express our gratitude to Professor Catarina Carnaz for answering our question regarding this project and giving us the opportunity to visit the PwC offices in Lisbon.
Breathing in its spaces has been an incredible human experience and more valuable and extremely formative for our future professional careers.

Observing in person the company's attention to all the details of the company in its initiatives to meet the needs of its employees has helped us to better comprehend how PwC is a unique reality, and it has certainly contributed to understand how PwC strives to be a great place to work for today's and tomorrow's talents.

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